

RAJAT KULSHRESHTHA

Engineering Manager

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SUMMARY

Engineering Manager with 11+ years at PayPal running high-scale, customer-facing product platforms. Led a **10+ engineer team** and unified **30+ engineers** end to end at **four-nines availability with zero P0/P1s**. Hands-on in Java, Spring Boot and microservices; strong in architecture, security and operational ownership. Led the team's adoption of **AI-assisted, agentic engineering** (Claude) and shipped **AI-enabled tools** into daily use. Partners with **Product Managers** on outcomes; builds **high-performing teams** through coaching and hiring (**Diploma in Coaching and Mentoring**).

CORE SKILLS

Leadership: Engineering management, people management and coaching, hiring and performance management, roadmapping and OKRs, stakeholder and product partnership, agile delivery, leading through change and ambiguity.

Engineering: Architecture and system design, microservices, REST and GraphQL APIs, security, observability and alerting, operational ownership (SLAs, triage), performance and scalability, ROI-driven technology decisions, AI-assisted and agentic engineering, LLM context design.

Technology: Java, Spring Boot, SQL, Kafka, Docker, Git, Jenkins, Claude, Datadog, Splunk, OpenAPI/Swagger, JUnit, TestNG, C++, Bash.

EXPERIENCE

PayPal India Private Limited, Bengaluru, India

Jul 2015 – Sep 2026

Manager, Software Development (Engineering Manager), Activity Services

Jul 2022 – Sep 2026

- **Led 10+ engineers** owning the transaction listing, search and details APIs behind PayPal's in-app (**32%+ engagement**) and email (**27%+ engagement**) post-transaction experiences; delivered **90+ product, 25+ strategic, 35+ security** and 10+ tech-excellence initiatives.
- **AI-assisted engineering:** led the team's AI adoption, setting up innovation processes to avoid duplicate AI use cases across the org, and built an "**LLM Wiki**", a shared context layer (repo conventions, coding standards, architecture rules, domain documentation) that lets AI agents work as domain experts, refined through a feedback-driven loop.
- **Agentic SDLC workflow (built with Claude):** three plugins covering architecture and planning (6 agents), feature development from Jira requirements to PR (10 agents) and PR review, built bottom-up from single-purpose agents; **30%+ faster requirements-to-review**, lets developers new to our systems contribute, now being tested on system bugs.
- **AI-enabled products on the LLM Wiki:** a domain-support Slack bot (**60% less developer time** on domain questions, **70% shorter wait** for first response from other teams, including cross-geo); Datadog and Splunk alert triage that analyses deviations against code, recent rollouts and downstream dependencies; a Jira agent turning sprint-planning documents into stories with acceptance criteria (**40%+ less Jira effort** per person).
- **Partnered with Product and Program** leads: instituted Product–Program–Engineering syncs (OKRs, risk and resource planning); prioritised requests from 100+ product requesters by ROI within compliance and governance; briefed senior executives weekly.
- **Owned operations:** sustained four-nines availability and low client-facing latency with **zero P0/P1s**; built alerting, exception-handling and triage processes; supported 300+ Jira tickets and 1k+ queries.
- **Re-architected a business-critical (Tier-1) system:** **3x throughput, 50%+ lower CPU, 450+ fewer VMs, USD 300K+ annual savings**; built a plug-and-play shadow framework for low-risk re-architecture; led multi-year initiatives cutting legacy cost and lifting performance 20%+.
- **Led a new anti-spam platform:** nominated by Senior Director+ leadership to lead a 7+ engineer backend, web and app team on PayPal's top-priority spam initiative; delivered end-to-end **a month ahead of target**.
- Raised **sprint throughput 25%+ and say-do ratio 70%+**; cleared a 3-year-old backlog of 100+ tickets, winning back 10+ merchants (USD 5M+ payment volume); led 60%+ of inbound intake, accelerating program alignment 50%+.
- **Grew the team:** hired 4, promoted 2; monthly 1:1s with structured feedback; onboarded 3 interns (all secured pre-placement offers); **Glint performance score 91/100**, 14 points above PayPal management and highest in the Consumer org (2023); built a Slack bot that turns daily reflections into weekly kudos and monthly growth summaries.

Member of Technical Staff 1, Activity Services

Mar 2022 – Jun 2022

- Led migration of "Actions in Activities" to eventual consistency: **70% lower latency, USD 480K/year saved**, 1B+ daily real-time API calls and 6B+ daily SQL queries removed.
- Launched GraphQL loading for the Activities detail page (1+ s latency and 60+ real-time API calls removed); evaluated ES infrastructure ROI and rebuilt "Did you mean" search on existing platform capabilities, **saving USD 220K/year** with zero customer impact.

Software Engineer 3, Activity Services

Feb 2020 – Mar 2022

- Led **15+ engineers** for 1.5 years to **decommission 4 legacy services** (10+ years old): USD 700K/year infrastructure saved, 100K+ lines of code removed, 25x+ faster in 7 product searches.
- Led 8 engineers on **X-Geo enablement:** platform redesign and regulatory-compliant data migration for millions of customers, China financial-audit compliance, and the launch of PayPal payments products in China.
- Cut Search API latency **20x** (parallelised database reads) and "Actions in Activities" latency 3x (3.5 s to under 1 s); 500+ code reviews as platform owner.

Software Engineer 2, Activity Services

Feb 2017 – Feb 2020

- Led 5 engineers building **Enterprise Audit** for large merchants in 10+ economies; drove platform integrations with Android Pay, Samsung Pay and Apple.
- Led a **security upgrade** (client authentication, data encryption in transit); built self-serve platform architecture (**3x faster time to market**), a Refund credit ETA tracker (5K fewer daily customer contacts) and a CI jobs dashboard (10K+ developer hours saved).

- Migrated 2 customer-facing APIs (300M+ daily requests) to a new stack, **cutting deployment time 97.5%**; primary contact for P0/P1 issues from Intuit, Google and Microsoft.

EDUCATION, CERTIFICATIONS AND AWARDS

Indian Institute of Technology Guwahati, India **2011 – 2015**
B.Tech, Electronics and Electrical Engineering, Minor in CS; GPA 8.93/10; Institute Silver Medal (EEE, 2015).
Professional Diploma in Coaching and Mentoring, Kingstown College, Ireland **Nov 2024 – Jun 2025**
PayPal Manager Benchmark Certification (2024). **English:** IELTS 7.5/9 (CEFR C1).
Awards: PayPal Star of the Month (2021), Heroes (2020), 12 Spot Rewards, 11 Bravo! recognitions; 1st in PayPal Bangalore SecForce security championship (2019).
Additional material: drive.google.com/drive/folders/13Bf0HafvCIkevoNJ00SZOg74DJxv4I3P